



Drone Delivery Gets A Lift

As the FAA lays out its new set of safety rules, licensed drone deliveries get one step closer to reality. <http://digit.in/jan21-53>



Zoom-ing Forward...

Zoom could launch a web-based email service and calendar app to compete with Google and Microsoft. <http://digit.in/jan21-54>



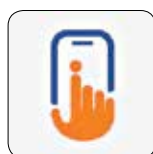
Credit: PhotographerIncognito / Shutterstock.com

Indian Governance apps

Pocketable access to official services

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There are many well designed, easy to use and powerful apps launched by the government, but there is little fanfare about these releases. The application stores are flooded with predatory imitations, which is why it is necessary to check for the authenticity of the app, and one big clue is the developer. Gone are the days when you have to stand in long queues in dusty offices dealing with bored boomers, there is an app for that!



UMANG

Developer: MeitY, Government Of India

When it comes to accessing governance

resources through a mobile app, UMANG is the app to start with. It seamlessly integrates with many other government apps, platforms and systems including Aadhaar, Bharat Bill Payment System and DigiLocker. MeitY plans to integrate any future apps into UMANG as well. More than 841 services are available through the app already. Whether you want to find out how much the insurance on your crops will cost or access the results of an exam, the service is likely to be available on UMANG.



DigiLocker - a simple and secure document wallet

Developer: MeitY, Government of India

DigiLocker is the official app for digitisation of essential documents for the citizens of the country. On the service, users can store important documents such as driving licence, ration card, caste certificates, ration certificates, marks cards and so on.

There is a fetch function that allows for documents to be fetched directly from government servers, such as the papers for vehicle registration. Showing the documents on DigiLocker to officials such as traffic wardens is allowed. The government plans to release markshets in the future directly on the app.



ePathshala

Developer: NCERT

The ePathshala app is a single app for students, parents,

teachers and educators to access educational material on all platforms, including computers and smartphones. The biggest advantage of the app is the easy access to the textbooks for all standards. Students can also take courses and watch video lectures directly on the app, while teachers get access to various educational resources, supported by the curriculum. The app has been designed keeping in mind the low capacity devices, and has an initial memory footprint of just 7 MB.



mParivahan

Developer: NIC eGov Mobile Apps

The mParivahan app aims to be your one

stop shop for all the services provided by the regional transport office. Right now, it gives citizens a very powerful vehicle number lookup feature, that allows you to find out the owners of vehicles, and other details related to the vehicle such as year of manufacture and insurance status. The service is useful in identifying suspicious parked cars, or to investigate the ownership of second hand vehicles. The application also allows you to generate copies of driving licence and the RC booklet on demand.



mPassport Seva

Developer: Consular, Passport and Visa (CPV) Division

This is the app that